

The evidence

I consider that I have dealt adequately with the claim, so I now move on to the evidences, or the verification. A literature that claims supernatural origin should be intrinsically supernatural and should produce supernatural results. I will begin with the supernatural results, which will also tell us something about the Creator's purpose in giving the Revelation.

Paul wrote to Timothy: "from infancy you have known the Sacred Scriptures which are able to make you wise into salvation through the faith that is in Christ Jesus. All Scripture is God-breathed and is valuable for teaching, for reproving, for correcting, for training in righteousness, so that the man of God may be fully competent, thoroughly equipped for every good work"¹ (2 Timothy 3:15-17). Certainly one of the most important purposes is to show how to obtain eternal salvation. Paul goes on to say that Scripture is valuable for four things. Notice the sequence: 1) the Scripture provides objectively true information; 2) then the Holy Spirit uses His Sword to convict of sin; 3) this leads to repentance and conversion; 4) then the Word is our food and water for spiritual growth. As we grow, we can help others move through the sequence. A very great many Christians, from around the world, have found the above to be true in their personal experience.

Hebrews 4:12-13, "the Word of God is living and efficient, and sharper than any two-edged sword, actually penetrating to the point of separating soul and spirit,² joints and marrow; in fact, it is able to evaluate a heart's reflections and intentions. Nothing in all creation is hidden from His sight; rather all things are naked and open to the eyes of Him to whom we must give account." Meditating on God's Word can be rather uncomfortable; it is a 'mirror' that tells us the truth about ourselves (James 1:25). Ephesians 6:17 calls it "the sword of the Spirit". A word that can separate soul from spirit must be supernatural. A very great many Christians, from around the world, have found the above to be true in their personal experience. Returning to Hebrews 4:13, we must give an account to a Judge who knows ALL the facts. This knowledge really ought to turn us into serious people, diligent seekers of God, but . . .

"This Book of the law shall not depart from your mouth, but you shall meditate in it day and night, that you may observe to do according to all that is written in it. For then you will make your way prosperous, and then

¹ Access to Scripture is necessary for spiritual growth and work.

² If soul and spirit can be separated, they obviously cannot be the same thing, just as joints and marrow are not the same thing.